SHANTI DEVI LEGEND'S LEAGUE · SEASON 2

RULES & REGULATIONS

For owners, captains and players: who can play, how squads are built, the auction and the season.

Season 23 Jan – 14 Mar 2027 **Auction** 12 Dec 2026 **Venue** Essex Farms, Chhawla **Version** Draft · 3 Nov 2026

DECIDED
Approved by the League, including at the captains' meet on 30 Oct 2026.

PROPOSED
Drafted for sign-off; may change before the pool is published.

OPEN
Still to be decided. Listed in section 11.

01 THE LEAGUE

SLL-2 is Season 2 of the Shanti Devi Legend's League, a corporate cricket league for working professionals aged 30 and over. Playful Ventures Private Limited runs it ("the League"). DECIDED

ITEM	SEASON 2
Teams	14 franchises in two groups of seven
Matches	45: 42 league matches, two semi-finals, one final
Season	Sat 23 Jan – Sun 14 Mar 2027
Match days	Saturdays and Sundays at 8:00 AM, 11:30 AM and 3:00 PM; one match per team per weekend
Venue	Essex Farms Cricket Club & Academy, near Shokeen International School, Chhawla, New Delhi 110071
Auction	Saturday 12 December 2026
Registration	Closes 29 November 2026, 11:59 PM IST, on playfulventures.co.in/register

DEFINITIONS

TERM	MEANING
Franchise	One of the 14 Season 2 teams, held by its owner(s) for the season

TERM	MEANING
Pool	Players the League has approved, ranked and categorised for the auction
SPI	Shanti Devi Players Index: the score that ranks every pool player (separate methodology document)
Age bracket	Under 35, 35–39 or 40+, by completed age on the cut-off date in Rule 3.1
Category	Legend, A+, A or B: sets base price, cap, squad limits and playing XII limits
Professional cricket	International, IPL or other franchise T20, BCCI or board domestic, state, zonal or district teams at any age group, university representation, or any paid contract

02 PLAYER ELIGIBILITY AND REGISTRATION

2.1 **Age:** 30 or older on the cut-off date. DECIDED

2.2 **Working professionals only:** employees, founders, business owners and the self-employed. Each player gives their company, designation and own LinkedIn profile. DECIDED

2.3 **Non-professional players only:** no professional cricket in the 15 years before registration. Older history must be declared. DECIDED

2.4 **No paid players:** a player must never have charged or taken a fee to play for a team, and must not take money from any team or owner to play in SLL. If this turns out to be untrue, the player is barred from further SLL matches without refund. DECIDED

2.5 **Checks:** the League checks identity, age, employment and cricket history against public records. A matching record holds the registration until the player explains it. DECIDED

2.6 **Photo and documents:** a clear, recent face photo from every player; Aadhaar from new players; any player may be asked for ID or proof of employment. DECIDED

2.7 **No guarantee:** registering or paying does not guarantee approval, a place in the pool, a team or a game. DECIDED

2.8 **False declaration:** rejection or removal at any point, without refund, a ban from future seasons, and the team may lose the matches the player played. DECIDED

03 AGE BRACKETS AND CATEGORIES

Every approved player gets an SPI score and two ranks: one across the whole pool and one inside their age bracket. Categories follow from the bracket and the bracket rank, as the SPI methodology sets out.

3.1 **Cut-off date:** age is the player's completed years on Sunday 7 March 2027, the day of the last league match. DECIDED

Under 35 years

Every player is A+. A squad may hold at most 2 A+ players, and only 1 may be in the playing XII. DECIDED

35–39 years

Ranked by SPI within the bracket and by role. The top players, enough to cover every squad's A slots, are A; the rest are B. DECIDED

40+ years

Same method as 35–39, ranked only against other 40+ players: A and B. DECIDED

3.2 **Legends:** a player is a Legend if they are 60 or older on the cut-off date, **or** their career batting average is below 10 **and** their career strike rate is below 100. The Board may also name any player a Legend, or make an exception, on a reasonable basis that it records. A Legend keeps their SPI ranks but is placed in the Legend category, not A+, A or B. DECIDED

3.3 **Review:** a player may ask once, before the pool is published, for their category to be reviewed. The grading panel's decision is final. PROPOSED

3.4 **Freeze:** categories are frozen when the pool goes to owners and do not change after that. PROPOSED

04 SQUADS AND THE PLAYING XII

A squad holds at most 18 players and each match is played by a **playing XII**. The XII must meet both the age limits and the category limits below. DECIDED

AGE LIMITS IN THE PLAYING XII

AGE ON THE CUT-OFF DATE	IN THE PLAYING XII
Under 35	**Max 1**
35–39	**Max 4**

AGE ON THE CUT-OFF DATE	IN THE PLAYING XII
40 and over	Any number

CATEGORY LIMITS

CATEGORY	IN THE SQUAD	IN THE PLAYING XII
Legend	Up to 2	Max 1 (optional)
A+	Up to 2	1
A	Up to 6	**Max 6**
B	Up to 8	The rest
Total	**18**	**12**

Squad numbers are from the owners' deck. A Legend counts towards the age limit of their own age.

4.0 **Legend in the XII bats high:** a team does not have to pick a Legend. If it picks one in its playing XII, that Legend must bat in one of the top four positions in the batting order. DECIDED

4.1 **Team sheet:** the playing XII goes to the match referee before the toss. Only squad players may play. DECIDED

4.2 **Minimum on match day:** 12 fit squad players. DECIDED

4.3 **One team only:** a player stays with the franchise that bought them for the whole season. Trades need League approval. DECIDED

4.4 **Replacements:** a player injured for the season, withdrawn or removed may be replaced by an unsold pool player from the same age bracket and the same or a lower category, at that player's base price, from the remaining purse. The League approves every replacement. DECIDED

4.5 **Owners who play** count as one of the 18 and meet every eligibility rule. DECIDED

OWNERS AND RETAINED PLAYERS

Before the auction a franchise may name playing owners and retain players from Season 1. Both join the squad before the first lot and count towards the 18, the category limits and the playing XII limits. DECIDED

	PLAYING OWNERS	RETAINED PLAYERS
Most per team	**3**	**2**
Category	At most 2 A and 1 B	Exactly one A and one B
Age	35–39 allowed, but only as B	40 and over only
Who	Owners of the franchise who meet the eligibility rules	Players who played in SLL-1

4.6 **Retention is for SLL-1 players only.** A player who did not play Season 1 cannot be retained. DECIDED

4.7 **No under-35 retentions.** A+ players, and anyone else under 35, can only be bought at the auction (Rule 5.8). DECIDED

4.8 **Only owners may come from the 35–39 bracket before the auction,** and a 35–39 owner plays as B. Retained players must be 40 or over. DECIDED

4.9 **Category by SPI:** the category of an owner or a retained player is set by the SPI, like every other player's. DECIDED

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05 THE AUCTION

The auction is on Saturday 12 December 2026. Each owner bids from a ₹5,00,000 purse and may add a ₹1,00,000 top-up, taking it to ₹6,00,000. DECIDED

SETTING	VALUE
Franchise fee	₹5,00,000 DECIDED
Purse	₹5,00,000, plus an optional ₹1,00,000 top-up DECIDED
Squad size	Up to 18 DECIDED

BASE PRICES, RAISES AND CAPS

CATEGORY	BASE PRICE	RAISE BY	CAP
Legend	₹15,000	₹5,000	₹50,000
A+	₹35,000	₹10,000	₹75,000
A	₹35,000	₹10,000	₹75,000

CATEGORY	BASE PRICE	RAISE BY	CAP
B	₹20,000	₹5,000	₹50,000

From the owners' deck (playfulventures.co.in/owners). These figures may change up to one week before the auction.

5.1 **Lot order:** Legends first, then A+, then A, then B. Order inside a category is drawn at random and shown on screen. DECIDED

5.2 **Bidding:** the auctioneer calls each player, their bracket, category, SPI rank and base price. Each raise is the category's step. A bid above the category cap, or one that breaks a squad limit or the 18 maximum, is refused. PROPOSED

5.3 **Secret tender at the cap:** when two or more owners reach a category's cap, the player goes to a secret tender at the capped price. How a tie in the tender is settled (for example a chit draw) is still open. DECIDED

5.4 **Purse protection:** no bid may leave too little to fill the remaining slots at base price. PROPOSED

5.5 **Unsold players** go to a second round after every lot has been called once. PROPOSED

5.6 **No approaches:** owners must not contact, promise money or favours to, or agree terms with any pool player before the auction. DECIDED

5.7 **Record:** the live board and the League's sale record are final. Unspent purse has no cash value. DECIDED

5.8 **A+ only through the auction:** A+ players cannot be retained. Every A+ player in a squad must be bought at the auction. DECIDED

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06 FIXTURES AND FORMAT

6.1 Each group plays a single round robin: 6 league matches per team, 21 per group. DECIDED

6.2 Every team gets at least 24 hours between matches; in practice the gap is at least 137 hours, because each team plays once per weekend. DECIDED

6.3 The top two of each group reach the semi-finals on Sat 13 Mar (A1 v B2 at 8:00 AM, B1 v A2 at 11:30 AM). The final is Sun 14 Mar at 11:30 AM. DECIDED

6.4 **Table:** 2 points for a win, 1 for a tie or no result, 0 for a loss; ties on points split by net run rate, then head-to-head. PROPOSED

6.5 The League may move a fixture for weather, ground or safety reasons and tells both teams in good time. DECIDED

07 PLAYING CONDITIONS

The full playing conditions are issued before the season. Points already fixed or proposed:

7.1 **Reporting:** teams report 45 minutes before the start; the toss is 15 minutes before. PROPOSED

7.2 **Walkover:** a team not ready to start 30 minutes after the scheduled time forfeits the match. PROPOSED

7.3 **Kit:** full team kit on the field and in the team area. DECIDED

7.4 **Officials:** umpires' and match referees' decisions are final on the field. DECIDED

7.5 **Legends' runs:** any special scoring for Legends (for example, runs counted double up to a cap) is still to be decided and will be sent to all teams before the season. OPEN

7.6 Overs, powerplay, bowler limits, the ball and the rain rule: to be issued. OPEN

08 FEES AND PAYMENTS

FEE	AMOUNT	REFUND
Registration	₹1,000 with the registration	Only if the League rejects the profile as not eligible to play DECIDED
Selected player	₹4,000 from each player a team buys, by the League's deadline	Not refundable DECIDED
Franchise	₹5,00,000 per franchise, plus ₹1,00,000 if the top-up is taken	Per the franchise agreement DECIDED

A bought player who has not paid the ₹4,000 by the deadline may be removed so the team can replace them. DECIDED

09 CONDUCT, FAIR PLAY AND PENALTIES

9.1 Respect players, officials, organisers, staff and spectators: no abuse, threats or violence, and no remarks about anyone's religion, caste, gender, region or

background. DECIDED

9.2 No smoking, vaping or tobacco at the venue; no alcohol or intoxicants on match days. Change only in the changing area. DECIDED

9.3 No betting on any SLL match, no fixing and no passing inside information. Breaking this means a lifetime ban and a possible police report. DECIDED

9.4 Playing under a false name or age, or letting someone else play in your place, means removal without refund, and the team may lose the matches concerned. DECIDED

9.5 Penalties range from a warning to a fine (fines schedule to be set), suspension for one or more matches, or removal. Removal is without refund. DECIDED

9.6 Before a serious penalty the League hears the player's side. DECIDED

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10 DISPUTES AND CHANGES

10.1 One appeal, in writing within 48 hours, to the League's governing council. Its decision is final. PROPOSED

10.2 Auction-night complaints go to the League in writing within 24 hours. DECIDED

10.3 The League may change fixtures, timings, the format or these rules, and will tell teams and players in good time. The version date on this document shows which rules apply. DECIDED

10.4 Indian law applies, and the courts at Gurugram, Haryana have jurisdiction. DECIDED

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11 STILL TO DECIDE

From the captains' meet on 30 Oct and these drafts. Each needs a League decision before the pool is published.

- [ ] Does the A+ player count towards the 6 A players allowed in the playing XII?
- [ ] Special scoring for Legends, if any
- [ ] What a playing owner and a retained player cost against the purse (for example their category base price), and the deadline for naming them
- [ ] Can an owner under 35 play?
- [ ] How a tie in the secret tender is settled (chit draw?)
- [ ] Prize money split between owners and players; the 60:40 model and what each share means; secret poll
- [ ] Owners' amount brackets: submission deadline and review

- [ ] Overs, powerplay, ball, rain rule and the fines schedule
- [ ] Admin visibility of team compositions
